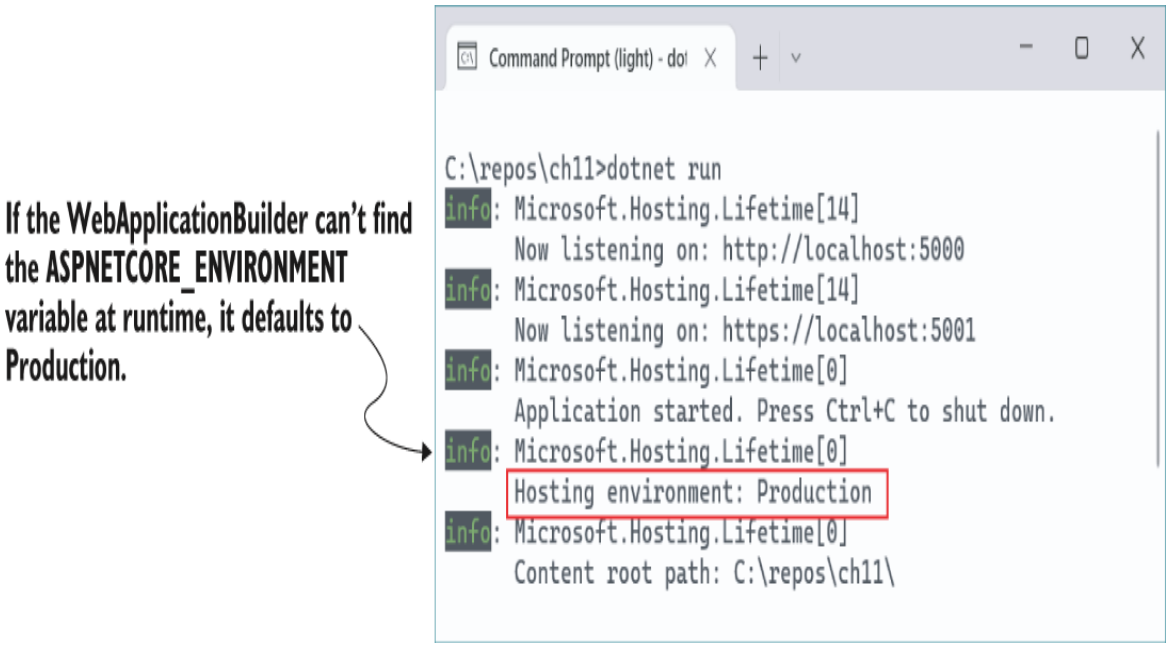


Figure 10.6 By default, ASP.NET Core applications run in the production hosting environment. You can override this default by setting the `ASPNETCORE_ENVIRONMENT` variable.

TIP By default, the current hosting environment is logged to the console at startup, which can be useful for checking that the environment variable has been picked up correctly.

Another option is to use a launchSettings.json file to control the environment. All the default ASP.NET Core applications include this file in the Properties folder. LaunchSettings.json defines profiles for running your application.

TIP You can use *profiles* to run your application with different environment variables. You can also use profiles to emulate running on Windows behind *Internet Information Services* (IIS) by using the IIS Express profile. I rarely use this profile, even in Windows, and always choose the `http` or `https` profile.

Listing 10.16 shows a typical launchSettings.json file that defines three profiles: `http`, `https`, and `IIS Express`. The first two profiles are equivalent to using `dotnet run` to run the project. The `http` profile listens only for